

Samsung rolls out Nexus S in India

Samsung has officially launched the Google Nexus S smartphone in India. It is the first phone to ship with Gingerbread, the newest build of Google Android, and is priced at Rs 30,400. However, some of the online shopping sites like Flikart.com have been offering the device for a price much lower than the current launch price.

The phone packs in a 1 GHz processor, a 5 MP rear camera, a VGA front camera and an NFC chip that helps in wireless mobile payments.



Android-based HCL ME tablets launched in India

HCL Infosystems has had a soft launch of its new range of Android-based tablet PCs—the HCL ME Tablets, in India. Available in 17.8 cm (7 inch) and 25.4 cm (10 inch) screen sizes and three price points (Rs 14,990, Rs 25,790 and Rs 32,990), the new tablets are in competition with Dell's Streak, OlivePad, Samsung's Galaxy Pad, Notion Ink's Adam and Apple's iPad.



The entry-level HCL ME AE7 comes with an 800 MHz processor, a 17.8-cm display, memory specifications of 256 MB DDR2, NAND Flash of 2 GB (in-built), and a micro SD card to expand capacity up to 8 GB, besides 802.11 b/g Wi-Fi support. The mid-level HCL ME AM7 and the top-end HCL ME AP10A are more feature-rich.

Facebook prepares to get into computer hardware

Facebook, the company that revolutionised social networking on the Internet, now wants a say in computer hardware as well. It has joined hands with companies like Hewlett Packard, Dell, Advanced Micro Devices and Intel to launch the Open Compute Project. At its headquarters in Palo Alto, California, the social networking giant recently open sourced the specifications and design documents for the custom-built servers, power supplies, racks, battery backup systems and other equipment used at its new Prineville, Oregon data centre.

"It's time to stop treating data centre design like Fight Club and demystify the way these things are built," said Jonathan Heiliger, vice president of technical operations at Facebook.

The project aims to offer specifications and designs for more power-efficient computers that are specifically geared toward running Internet services, shared openly with other companies.

"What we learned as we transitioned from being a small start-up (one office in a garage) to where we are today (a slightly bigger start-up) is that there are a couple of ways you can go about designing data centres and servers. You can build them yourself and work with ODMs (original design manufacturers) or you



Is LG looking at MeeGo for smartphones?

While Nokia may have abandoned the open source MeeGo operating system in favour of Windows Phone, companies like LG Electronics, China Mobile and ZTE are stepping in to develop smartphones and tablets based on MeeGo. The Linux-based mobile operating system project was first launched by Intel and Nokia at Mobile World Congress in February 2010, but a year later, MeeGo was left in the hands of Intel as Nokia pulled back from the project to focus on Microsoft software instead.

It is believed that the Finnish handset maker's exit may actually benefit the project as other manufacturers previously stayed away due to Nokia's dominant role in the platform's development.

"It's opening opportunities for the others to come in," Valtteri Halla, a member of the technical steering group of MeeGo, told a developer conference. "Discussions are taking place. You'll see things coming out this year, pretty soon."

According to an LG spokesman, the



company is collaborating with

MeeGo in various working groups.

"At this point in time, LG has no definitive plans to mass produce devices with MeeGo other than car infotainment systems," the spokesman said.